"A Similitude of God and His Only Begotten Son"

The Akedah and the Atonement

Jacob 4:5 · Genesis 22 · The Abrahamic Covenant

LET'S READ — Jacob 4:5

> *"…behold, they believed in Christ and worshiped the Father in his name… Abraham's offering…was a similitude of God and his Only Begotten Son."*

THE PARALLELS

The Akedah — Genesis 22	The Atonement
Isaac — "only begotten" of Abraham & Sarah (Heb. 11:17)	Jesus — Only Begotten of the Father (John 3:16)
Isaac carries the wood for his own sacrifice (v. 6)	Christ carries His own cross (John 19:17)
A ram substituted — Isaac is spared (v. 13)	**No substitution.** The Father does not stop what Abraham was stopped from finishing.
Jehovah-Jireh — "YHWH will be seen" (v. 14)	On a hill outside Jerusalem — God is finally, fully seen

The Akedah is not primarily a story about Abraham's obedience — though it is that. It is primarily a similitude, a prefiguration, a type. The entire scene is constructed to point beyond itself.

The hinge detail: In the Akedah, a ram appears in the thicket at the last moment. Isaac is spared. The ram is the substitute. But in the Atonement — **there is no ram.** The Father does not call it back. The angel does not stay the hand.

This is the interpretive key that Jacob 4:5 opens for us: Abraham's willingness was the type; the Father's completed sacrifice is the antitype. **Abraham almost gave his son. The Father actually did.**